Career Corner

Some careers in disaster management are

- Emergency Management Director
- Emergency Management Specialist
- Floodplain Management Specialist
- Technological Hazards Program Specialist
- Fire Inspector and Investigator

Grammar

Active and Passive Forms

Let us understand

In a sentence the action of a subject in relation to the object can be expressed in two ways.

The fireman saved Senthil.

Senthil was saved by the fireman.

In the first sentence, the subject (the fireman) is the doer of the action.

In the second sentence, the subject (Senthil) is acted upon.

The meaning in both sentences is the same but the focus on the subject changes and the doer of the action takes a secondary role in the passive sentence.

- In the active form, the subject completes the action of the sentence.
- It starts with a subject, followed by a verb and objects.

E.g. **Alexander** cut **the Gordian knot**.
(Subject) (verb) (object)

In the Passive Form, the object in the active form becomes the subject.

The Gordian knot was cut **by Alexander**.
(Subject) (Verb) (Doer)

DO YOU KNOW?

The Gordian Knot is a legend of Phrygian Gordium associated with Alexander the Great. It is often used as a metaphor for an intractable problem (disentangling an "impossible" knot) solved easily by "thinking outside the box" ("cutting the Gordian knot").

Note that the form of the verb changes when we express a sentence in the passive voice.

In other words, the passive form is used when the action is the focus, not the subject.(e.g.) The bridge is broken. (It is not known who broke the bridge, or it is not important to know who broke the bridge.)

The verb is changed to a 'be' verb+past participle. The subject of the active sentence follows 'by' or is omitted.

Active	Passive
The Chief Minister wrote a letter to The Prime Minister for immediate release of funds.	A letter was written to the Prime Minister by the Chief Minister for immediate release of funds.
The Corporation built a new bridge.	A new bridge was built by the Corporation.

In the following report, note the use of active and passive forms.

Daylight Robbery

Another incident of daylight robbery came to light when six robbers ransacked a house in broad daylight. The robbers acted as credit card dealers and gained entry into the house easily. The family of five was overpowered and the inmates couldn't raise an alarm. The robbers fled

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